



Five Reality Checks

Chennai Beware

The city has the highest cancer rate per 1,00,000

Top Slot

Lung cancers highest among men, breast in women

Capital Woes

At 11 per 1,00,000, Delhi women top global charts in gall bladder cancer

Midlife Crisis

Indian women between 45 and 55 are at a greater risk

Up in Smoke

Seven out of 10 tobacco-related deaths occur between age 30 and 69 in India

compounds are in the pipeline, just on cancer, although its spread is much less than as cardiovascular diseases or diabetes. "Cancer cells are so smart that you need that kind of investment," says Reddy. Clinical trials establish the efficacy of some of the new and exciting compounds that attack cancers at the molecular level. "They target growth signals that feed cancer cells, leave healthy cells unscathed, shrink tumours, help patients feel better and cause fewer side-effects than chemo," points out Reddy. Bevacizumab is the first in a decade to be approved in 2009 by the USFDA to treat the deadly glioblastoma. India, however, lags behind in clinical research. "We must do our own original studies or become the clinical trial call centre of the world," says Jalali.

The scope for innovation in surgery is often more limited. But new approaches are pouring out of the nation's OTs. Ask Badwe. He has managed to combine surgery with the body's natural rhythm. In a study, he

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